Economic Appendage of Another Country

The establishment of British rule in India was an entirely novel phenomenon for her, not comparable with any other invasion or political or economic change. 'India had been conquered before, but by invaders who settled within her frontiers and made themselves part of her life.' (Like the Normans in England or the Manchus in China.)' She had never lost her independence, never been enslaved. That is to say, she had never been drawn into a political and economic system whose centre of gravity lay outside her soil, never been subjected to & ruling class which was, and which remained, permanently alien in origin and character.'* Every previous ruling class, whether it had originally come from outside or was indigenous, had accepted the structural unity of India's social and economic life and tried to fit into it. It had become Indianised and had struck roots in the soil of the country. The new rulers were entirely different, with their base elsewhere, and between them and the average Indian there was a vast and

**K. S. Shelvankar: 'The Problem of India' (Penguin Special, London, 1940).*

unbridgeable gulf—a difference in tradition, in outlook, in income,